

28. During the Mughal period, the coins minted during the previous reign were called

- (a) Khajana (b) Chalni
(c) Mohur (d) Bikha

Jharkhand P.C.S. (Pre) 2023

Ans. (a)

The newly minted coin in the current or previous year was called Taza sikka (newly minted). The coins issued and in circulation in the reign of an emperor were called chalani (current), while the coins minted in the earlier reigns were called Khazana.

29. The meaning of word Bantai during the Medieval period was?

- (a) Religious Tax
(b) System of calculating revenue
(c) Wealth tax
(d) Property tax

48th to 52nd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2008

Ans. (b)

The meaning of word 'Bantai' during the medieval period was a system of calculating revenue in which real produce was distributed between state and peasants. Sher Shah Suri opted 3 systems for calculating revenue :

Nasq/Muktai/Kankut

Nakadi or Jabti

Galla Bakshi or Bantai

Bantai was of 3 types (i) Khet Bantai (ii) Lank Bantai (iii) Raasi Bantai.

30. Which of the following systems were prevailing basis of land revenue collection in the Deccan during the reign of Akbar?

- (a) Kankut (b) Number of plows
(c) Zabt (d) Gallabakshi

U.P. P.C.S. (Pre) 2017

Ans. (b)

In J.N. Sarkar's book 'History of Aurangzeb', it has been mentioned on page number 190, that in North India during the reign of Akbar systematic method of land revenue collection was established by Dewan Todarmal, but this type of systematic method was not found in the Deccan. During this period the farmers of the Deccan used to pay land revenue to the state on per plough (number of plough) basis.

31. Which of the following Mughal period canals, was constructed by restoring the Rajabwah of Firuz Shah?

- (a) Shekhnu-Ni (b) Shahab Nahr
(c) Nahr-i-Bihisht (d) Nahr-i-Agra

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2020

Ans. (b)

Mughal era Shahab (Shihab) Canal was constructed by reinvigorating Firuz Shah's canal Rajabwah. In the time of Akbar, first Shihabuddin Khan & later Nuruddin Muhammad tar reconstructed the canal. During the time of Akbar, Governor of Delhi, Sihabuddin Khan, repaired the canal for irrigation purposes & changed its name to Shahab Canal.

Music and Paintings of Mughal Period

*War scenes, birds, animals and sceneries were illustrated in Mughal paintings. **Humayun** started the **Mughal style** of painting. He met two distinguished painters, Khwaja Abdus Samad and Mir Sayyid Ali, during the years of his exile in Persia and Afghanistan. From these artists Humayun and his son Akbar learned lessons in drawing and painting.

***Akbar** got a number of texts painted. The first one was '**Dastan-i-Amir Hamza**'. Almost 50 painters took part in its preparation, first under the supervision of Mir Sayyid Ali and later, under Abdus Samad. There were about 1400 paintings in it. This book mentioned the heroic work of the Persian hero, Amir Hamza (uncle of Muhammad Sahib).

*The art of Mughal painting reached great heights during **Jahangir's reign**. Jahangir was a highly skilled connoisseur of painting. **Abul Hasan** (the title of **Nadir-ul-Zama**), **Ustad Mansur (Nadir-ul-Asra)**, **Faruq Begh**, **Bishan Das**, **Aqa Reza**, **Muhammad Nadir**, **Muhammad Murad**, Manohar, Madhav, Govardhan, etc were the main artists of Jahangir's court. Abul Hassan made a painting of Jahangir's coronation. This painting is inscribed in the Jahangir's autobiography 'Tujuk-i-Jahangiri' on the main page. Thus, Jahangir's period was called '**Golden Age of Mughal Paintings**'.

*'Pahari School', 'Rajput School', 'Mughal School' and 'Kangra School' are different styles of medieval painting.

*Aurangzeb banned the music as he found it as anti-Islamic, but during the same period, most books on Indian classical music were written in the Persian language. Despite being anti-music. Aurangzeb was a skilled instrumentalist who used to play the Indian instrument called '**Veena**'.

*'**Todi**' Raga is used to sing early in the morning. It was sung by Bhatos and Charans in the emperor's court.

*During the reign of Akbar, **Tansen** and **Swami Haridas** were prominent Dhrupad singers. Tansen was a famous musician of Akbar's court. Tansen's original name was **Ramtanu Pandey**. He was one of the Akbar's Navratanas. Before coming to the court of Akbar, Tansen was in the court of King Ramchandra of Rewa from where Akbar summoned him to his court and gave a very high post.

*Akbar had given Tansen the title of '**Kanthabarnvanivilas**'.

***Vilas Khan** was the chief musician of Jahangir's court. The prominent singers of the court of Shah Jahan were Jagannath, Ramdas, Sukhsen, Sursen, Lal Khan, Durrang Khan, etc.

Khyal singing became popular in the time of Muhammad Shah '**Rangila**'.

*The Kishangarh style of Rajasthan is known throughout India for its depiction of courtesan paintings. Raja Sawant Singh was the real inspiration behind the famous **Kishangarh** School of Painting. The main artists of this style, were **Amirchand, Chhotu, Bhawanidas, Nihalchand, Sitaram** etc. *The famous portrait of '**Bani-Thani**' which is in Kishangarh style, was made by **Nihalchand**.

1. Which statement is true about the Mughal paintings ?

- (a) Battle Scene
- (b) Animals, birds and natural scenes
- (c) Courtier depicting
- (d) All of the above

U.P. P.C.S. (Pre) 1991

Ans. (d)

The Mughal paintings have played a landmark role in the history of Indian paintings. All the above options are related to Mughal paintings. These paintings were a unique blend of Indian, Persian and Islamic paintings. Ustad Mansur was a 17th Century Mughal painter and court artist. He grew in acclaim during the reign of Jahangir (1605-1627). During that period he excelled at depicting the paintings based on nature, plants, birds, and animals.

2. The foundation of the Mughal painting was laid by –

- (a) Akbar
- (b) Humayun
- (c) Jahangir
- (d) Shah Jahan

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2012

U.P. U.D.A./L.D.A. (Mains) 2010

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2009

Ans. (b)

Humayun laid the foundation of Mughal painting during the years of his exile in Persia and Afghanistan. He met two distinguished Painters, Khwaja Abdus Samad and Mir Sayyid Ali. It was from these artists that Humayun and his son Akbar took lessons in drawing. An advanced atelier was set up in the palace.

3. Which Mughal ruler established Karkhanas for painting?

- (a) Humayun
- (b) Akbar
- (c) Jahangir
- (d) Shah Jahan
- (e) None of the above/More than one of the above

66th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2020

Ans. (b)

Akbar was very fond of painting and during his reign, painting was organised as an imperial establishment or Karkhana called Tasvir Khana where the painters worked. So, option (b) is the correct option.

4. The Mughal School of Painting formed the spinal cord of the various Schools of Indian miniature art. Which one of the following painting styles was not affected by Mughal painting?

- (a) Pahari
- (b) Rajasthani
- (c) Kangra
- (d) Kalighata

I.A.S. (Pre) 1995

Ans. (d)

The Mughal schools of painting from the Mughal court spread to various regional centres and gave rise to Pahari, Rajasthani and Kangra school of painting but Kalighata school of painting was Indigenous and not affected by Mughal painting.

5. Who did illustrate "Dastan-i-Amir Hamza"?

- (a) Abdus Samad
- (b) Mansur
- (c) Mir Sayyid Ali
- (d) Abul Hasan

46th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2004

Ans. (a) & (c)

Most of the Mughals were renowned as great patrons of arts. The first endeavour was to complete the pictures of the earliest Mughal illustrated manuscript, the Dastan-i-Amir Hamza began in the period of Humayun. It took 15 years to finish under the supervision of Mir Sayyid Ali and Abdus Samad more than 50 artists completed it.

6. 'Daswant and Basawan' famous painters were courtiers of Mughal Emperor :

- (a) Akbar
- (b) Jahangir
- (c) Shahjahan
- (d) Aurangzeb
- (e) None of the above/More than one of the above

60th to 62nd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2016

Ans. (a)

Daswant and Basawan were famous painters in Akbar's Court. Akbar was so impressed by the work of Daswant, that he supported him to become the leading painter of his time. Name of painters of Akbar era have been mentioned in the book Ain-i-Akbari by Abul Fazl – Daswant, Basawan, Keshav Lal, Mukund, Mishkin, Farrukh, Jagan, Mahesh, Khemkaran, Tara, Sanwal, and Harivansh, Rai etc.

7. European paintings were introduced in the court of :

- (a) Humayun
- (b) Akbar
- (c) Jahangir
- (d) Shah Jahan
- (e) None of the above/More than one of the above

63rd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2017

Ans. (b)

European paintings were introduced in the court of Akbar through Portuguese. Mughal painters received two specialities from them -

1. Portrait of person
2. To make objects seen further in the scene small in size.
Development of painting started in Humayun period.
European influence on Mughal paintings started during Akbar. Mishkin was an European painter in Akbar Court.

8. Who among the following were Jahangiri painters?
Select the correct answer for the codes given below –
1. Abdus Samad 2. Abul Hasan
3. Aqa Riza 4. Mir Sayyid Ali
Code :
(a) 1 and 2 (b) 2 and 3
(c) 3 and 4 (d) 4 and 1

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2012

Ans. (b)

Abul Hasan, Ustad Mansur, Farrukh Begh, Bishan Das, Aqa Reza, Muhammad Nadir, Muhammad Murad, Manohar, Govardhan were the main artists of Jahangir period. Mir Sayyid Ali and Abdus Samad laid the foundation of the Mughal painting during the period of Humayun.

9. Who among the following is not a painter of Jahangir's period?
(a) Mansur (b) Manohar
(c) Khwaja Abdus Samad (d) Abul Hasan

Jharkhand P.C.S. (Pre) 2023

Ans. (c)

Khwaja Abdus Samad was a painter during the reign of Humayun and Akbar, whereas Mansur, Manohar and Abul Hasan were painters of Jahangir's time. During Jahangir's reign (1605-27 A.D.) Mughal painting reached its zenith. He took inspiration from his life events and pushed for paintings on those scenarios rather than illustrations in fiction.

10. During whose reign did the "Mughal Painting" flourish?
(a) Aurangzeb (b) Akbar
(c) Jahangir (d) Shah Jahan

Uttarakhand Lower Sub. (Pre) 2010

Ans. (c)

Jahangir (1605-27) had an artistic inclination. During his reign, Mughal painting developed further as Jahangir was fascinated with art, science and architecture from a young age. He showed a leaning towards painting and had an atelier of his own. His interest in portraiture led to much development in this art form. The art of Mughal painting reached great heights during Jahangir's reign. His interest in painting also served his scientific interest in nature. Painter Ustad Mansur became one

of the best artists to document the animals and plants which Jahangir either encountered on his military expeditions or received as donations. Jahangir maintained a huge aviary and kept a record of every specimen and organized experiments. He patronized the European and Persian arts.

11. Jahangir mainly patronized which of the following arts?
(a) Painting (b) Architecture
(c) Sculpture (d) Music

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2016

Ans. (a)

See the explanation of the above question.

12. Who among the following Mughal Emperors shifted emphasis from illustrated manuscripts to albums and individual portraits?
(a) Humayun (b) Akbar
(c) Jahangir (d) Shah Jahan

I.A.S. (Pre) 2019

Ans. (c)

Jahangir particularly encouraged paintings depicting events of his own life, individual portraits, and studies of birds flowers and animals.

13. The 'Pahari School,' 'Rajput School,' 'Mughal School' and 'Kangra School' represent different styles in the art of :
(a) Architecture (b) Painting
(c) Dancing (d) Music

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 1994

Ans. (b)

The 'Pahari School,' 'Rajput School,' 'Mughal School' and 'Kangra School' are different styles of medieval painting. The paintings in different hill states of the north-western Himalayan region are said to be the hill paintings. It comprises the area of Himachal Pradesh, Jammu and Kashmir and area of Tehri Garhwal and Paudi Garhwal of Uttarakhand.

14. 'Kishan Garh' School is famous for –
(a) Temple Art (b) Painting
(c) Martial Arts (d) Sculpture
(e) None of these

Chhattisgarh P.C.S. (Pre) 2014

Ans. (b)

'Kishan Garh' school is famous for painting. It is a part of Rajasthan. Its style of painting is known for the beautiful depiction of a courtesan known as Bani Thani. Sawant Singh, a great scholar and patron of art and learning who ascended to the throne in 1748 A.D., was the real inspiration behind the famous Kishan Garh school of painting.

15. Which one of the following musical instruments was mastered by Aurangzeb ?

- (a) Sitar (b) Pakhawaj
(c) Veena (d) None of the above

**U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2010
U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2007**

Ans. (c)

Aurangzeb banned music in India as he found it anti-Islamic. But it is also the fact that during his tenure, most books on Indian classical music were written in the Persian language. Being anti-music, he was a great instrumentalist who used to play the Indian instrument called 'Veena'.

16. The Raga which is sung early in the morning, is—

- (a) Todi (b) Darbari
(c) Bhopali (d) Bhimpalasi

I.A.S. (Pre) 2000

Ans. (a)

'Todi' Raga is sung in the morning. Todi is a Hindustani classical Raga that gives its name to the Todi throat, one of the ten modes of the Hindustani classical music. It was sung by the minstrel in the emperor's court.

17. Musicians like Tansen, Baiju Bawra and Gopal Nayak had received training from the master Swami Haridas. How many music worship centres have been set up by the followers of Swami Haridas ?

- (a) 5 (b) 4
(c) 3 (d) 2

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2009

Ans. (a)

Swami Haridas was a spiritual poet and classical musician credited with a large body of devotional compositions, especially in the Dhrupad style. He was also the founder of Haridasi school of mysticism, still found today in North India. His followers built 5 worship training centres (ashrams). These are- Sri Banke Bihariji, Nidhivan, Temple of Gorelal, Sri Rasik Bihari and Thatti Khana.

18. With reference to Mian Tansen, which one of the following statements is not correct?

- (a) Tansen was the title given to him by Emperor Akbar.
(b) Tansen composed Dhrupads on Hindu gods and goddesses.
(c) Tansen composed songs on his patrons.
(d) Tansen invented many Ragas.

I.A.S. (Pre) 2019

Ans. (a)

The title of 'Tansen' was given by Raja Vikramjit Singh of Gwalior. Akbar gave the title of 'Mian'. About Tansen - Tansen also referred to as Tan Sen or Ramtanu

was a prominent figure of Hindustani classical music. He was born in a Hindu family. He began his career and spent most of his adult life in the court and patronage of the Hindu King of Rewa, Raja Ramchandra Singh, where Tansen's musical abilities & studies gained widespread fame. Thus, his fame got the attention of the Mughal Emperor Akbar, who sent messengers to Raja Ramchandra Singh, requesting Tansen to join the musicians at Mughal court. He was a Vaishnava musician.

19. The Dhrupad singers included in the reign of Akbar was/were

1. Tansen 2. Haridas
3. Surdas 4. Vilas Khan

Select the correct answer from the codes given below:

Code :

- (a) 1 and 2 (b) 2 and 3
(c) 1, 2 and 3 (d) All the four

U.P.P.S.C. (GIC) 2010

Ans. (a)

Tansen and Swami Haridas were the leading Dhrupad singers during Akbar's reign. Vilas Khan was the main singer during the reign of Jahangir.

20. Where is Tansen's tomb located ?

- (a) Agra (b) Gwalior
(c) Jhansi (d) Jaipur

M.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2010

U.P. P.C.S. (Pre) 1999

M.P. P.C.S. (Pre) 1991

Ans. (b)

Tansen is considered one of the greatest composer-musicians in Indian classical music. He lived during the period of the great Mughal Indian king Akbar. He was one of the nine jewels of his court. He first served as a court musician of the King Ramchandra of Rewa (Bhata Region) and then Emperor Akbar respectively. His tomb is located in Gwalior near the tomb of Saint Hazrat Ghaus whose teachings influenced him to convert to Islam.

21. Who among the following kings had given patronage to Tansen before Akbar?

- (a) Raja Ramchandra Singh of Bhata
(b) Rajbahadur of Malwa
(c) Uday Singh of Mewar
(d) Muzaffar Shah of Gujarat

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2019

Ans. (a)

See the explanation of above question.